



THE BOUNDLESS BRIEF · FREE RESOURCE

What Makes a Proposal Win

A winning proposal isn't about you, it's about making the client's decision easy. Seven principles behind proposals that actually get chosen.

- 1 Lead with their problem, not your bio.**
Open by showing you understand what they need. Your credentials land better after you've earned their attention.
- 2 Be specific about the outcome.**
Say what they'll get and how you'll get there. Vague reads as risky; specific reads as trustworthy.
- 3 Mirror the ask.**
Use their words and address every requirement they listed. It proves you actually read it.
- 4 Make scope and price unmistakable.**
No guessing. Clear deliverables, a clear number, a clear timeline.
- 5 Reduce the risk.**
Offer a small first step, a sample, or a clear process. Make saying yes feel safe.
- 6 Keep it short and skimmable.**
Respect their time. A tight one-pager beats a wall of text every time.
- 7 End with one clear next step.**
Tell them exactly what happens if they say yes. Don't make them figure it out.

These aren't theory. They're how a clear one-page proposal won a ~\$1,800 contract, with more in the pipeline.